



ITALIAN POCKET PISTOL

Date 1810

Origin Italy

Barrel 4¾in (12.3cm)

Caliber .85in (21.6mm)

Gunmaking flourished in post-Renaissance Italy (the English word “pistol” probably derives from Pistoia, a city famous for gun manufacture). Although the industry was in decline by the 19th century, craftsmen like Lamberti, creator of this pistol, still thrived.



FRENCH HOLSTER PISTOL

Date c.1810

Origin France

Barrel Not known

Caliber Not known

Military pistols like this were often well made and robust, but because they were smoothbore, they were not accurate and had limited range. Most were intended for use in extremely close combat. Cavalry usually relied on the sword as the principal weapon, and only used pistols as a last resort.



NEW LAND-PATTERN PISTOL

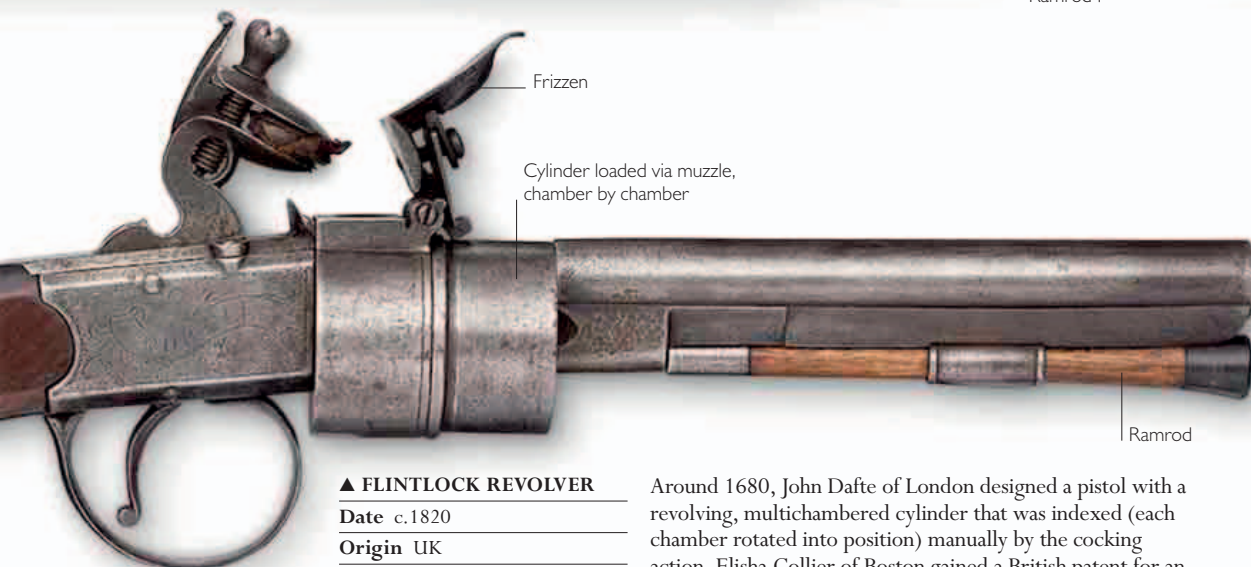
Date 1810

Origin UK

Barrel 9in (23cm)

Caliber .65in (16.5mm)

The British Army’s New Land-Pattern Pistol, introduced in 1802, was a competent, sturdy design that remained in service until flintlocks gave way to percussion (see pp.80–81) in the 1840s.



FLINTLOCK REVOLVER

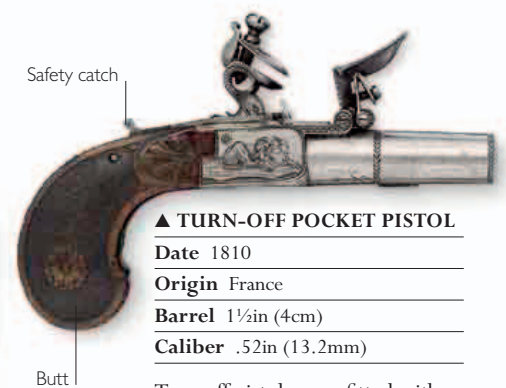
Date c.1820

Origin UK

Barrel 5in (12.4cm)

Caliber .45in (11.4mm)

Around 1680, John Dafte of London designed a pistol with a revolving, multichambered cylinder that was indexed (each chamber rotated into position) manually by the cocking action. Elisha Collier of Boston gained a British patent for an improved version in 1814, and it was produced in London by John Evans in 1819. This slender pistol is less bulky than Collier’s design, and was one of the many flintlock revolvers made by European gunmakers in the early 19th century.



TURN-OFF POCKET PISTOL

Date 1810

Origin France

Barrel 1½in (4cm)

Caliber .52in (13.2mm)

Turn-off pistols were fitted with barrels that could be unscrewed, or “turned off,” to reload at the breech. The screw-on barrel allowed this pistol to be loaded with a tighter-fitting ball and thus shoot both straighter and harder. Turn-off pistols were slow to reload, but their small size made them popular for self-defense.